ICT2162 · Management Information Systems

Worked Examples: Metrics and Data Quality

Original synthetic reading for demonstration and independent study. It is not an official syllabus, lecture note, or assessment specification.

Learning objectives

After this reading, a learner should be able to explain the central idea, apply it to a small example, and identify at least one assumption or limitation.

1. Main idea

A metric is useful when its meaning, source, time period, and limitations are documented. Completeness, validity, consistency, and timeliness are distinct aspects of data quality.

2. Example and reasoning

Before comparing course completion rates, define which enrollments count, ensure each result is finalized consistently, and check whether withdrawn students are included. Compare equivalent periods.

3. A method for practice

1. State the problem and define the terms that affect the answer.
2. Write down the assumptions and information available.
3. Work through a small example and make each step visible.
4. Check the result against a second case or independent explanation.
5. Summarize what the result supports and what it does not establish.

4. Questions for study

- Explain “worked examples: metrics and data quality” in your own words and give a new example.
- Which assumption matters most in the example, and how would the answer change if it were false?
- Describe one common mistake and a practical way to detect it.
- Write a short checklist another learner could use to review this work.

Reflection

Separate evidence from assumptions. If a conclusion depends on information not provided here, identify what would need to be verified.